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ST. AUGUSTINE

The bill now pending in Congress is the child of a storm, the product of the most turbulent motion the nation has ever known in peacetime.

FEBRUARY 9, 1964
Segregationist violence prompts St. Augustine, Florida, civil rights leader Robert Hayling to invite SCLC to join struggle

MAY 28
After the jailing of hundreds of demonstrators in St. Augustine, King appeals for outside assistance

JUNE 11
After King's arrest in St. Augustine, bi-racial committee is formed

JUNE
Why We Can't Wait is published

JULY 2
Attends the signing of Civil Rights Act of 1964

When 1963 came to a close, more than a few skeptical voices asked what substantial progress had been achieved through the demonstrations that had drawn more than a million Negroes into the streets. By the close of 1964, the pessimistic clamor was stilled by the music of major victories. Taken together, the two years marked a historical turning point for the civil rights movement; in the previous century no comparable change for the Negro had occurred. Now, even the most cynical acknowledged that at Birmingham, as at Concord, a shot had been fired that was heard around the world.

In the bursting mood that had overtaken the Negro, the words "compromise" and "retreat" were profane and pernicious. Our revolution was genuine because it was born from the same womb that always gives birth to massive social upheavals—the womb of intolerable conditions and unendurable situations. The Negro was determined to liberate himself. His